

Authentication & Security – Interview Answer Format

Q1. What authentication system did you implement in your project?

I implemented a JWT-based authentication system using Node.js and Express. Users can securely register and log in, and protected APIs are accessed only through valid JWT tokens.

Q2. How did you secure user passwords?

I used bcrypt to hash user passwords before storing them in the database. This ensures that even if the database is compromised, original passwords cannot be retrieved.

Q3. How does login work in your system?

During login, the entered password is compared with the hashed password stored in the database using bcrypt. If credentials are valid, a JWT token is generated and returned to the client.

Q4. What is JWT and why did you use it?

JWT (JSON Web Token) is a token-based authentication mechanism. I used it because it is stateless, secure, and suitable for protecting REST APIs.

Q5. How do you protect routes?

I created an authentication middleware that verifies the JWT token from the Authorization header. Only requests with valid tokens can access protected routes.

Q6. How did you manage sensitive data?

Sensitive information such as MongoDB URI and JWT secret are stored in environment variables using a .env file, which is excluded from GitHub using .gitignore.

Q7. What database security did you implement?

I used MongoDB Atlas with IP whitelisting and database user authentication to ensure secure cloud database access.

Summary:

This authentication system follows industry best practices including password hashing, token-based authentication, middleware protection, and environment-based security configuration.